# Class 10 SST - Chapter 12: Lifelines of National Economy

## 🌟 Introduction to the Chapter

The pace of development of a country depends upon the production of goods and services as well as their movement over space. Therefore, efficient means of transport are prerequisites for fast development.

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## 📌 Transport Systems in India

Transport can be classified into Land, Water, and Air transport.

### 1. Roadways

India has one of the largest road networks in the world. Roadways have preceded railways and still have an edge over them because of the lower construction cost and ability to traverse harder terrain.

- **Golden Quadrilateral Super Highways:** A six-lane highway project connecting Delhi-Kolkata-Chennai-Mumbai and Delhi.
- **National Highways (NH):** Link extreme parts of the country, maintained by CPWD.
- **State Highways:** Link a state capital with different district headquarters, maintained by PWD.

### 2. Railways

Railways are the principal mode of transportation for freight and passengers in India. They make it possible to conduct multifarious activities like business, sightseeing, pilgrimage, and transportation of goods over longer distances.

### 3. Pipelines

Pipeline transport network is a new arrival on the transportation map of India.

- Initially used to transport water to cities and industries.
- Now used to transport crude oil, petroleum products, and natural gas from oil and natural gas fields to refineries, fertilizer factories, and big thermal power plants.

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## ⚡ Waterways and Airways

### Waterways

Waterways are the cheapest means of transport. They are most suitable for carrying heavy and bulky goods.

- It is a fuel-efficient and environment-friendly mode of transport.
- *National Waterway No. 1:* The Ganga river between Allahabad and Haldia (1620 km).

### Airways

The air travel, today, is the fastest, most comfortable, and prestigious mode of transport.

- Important for covering difficult terrains like high mountains, dreary deserts, dense forests, and oceanic stretches with great ease.
- Air transport was nationalized in 1953.

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## ❌ Common Mistakes to Avoid

> [!WARNING]
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> 1. **Roadways vs Railways:** Do not blindly say railways are better. Roadways provide "door-to-door" service, which railways cannot. Roadways are best for short distance and low volume, while railways are best for long distance and high volume.
> 2. **Golden Quadrilateral Origin:** Implemented by the National Highway Authority of India (NHAI), not the CPWD.

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# 📝 Quick Revision

## Communication and Trade

- **Personal Communication:** Letters, emails, phones.
- **Mass Communication:** Provides entertainment and creates awareness among people about various national programs and policies (Radio, TV, Newspapers).
- **International Trade:** The exchange of goods among people, states, and countries is referred to as trade.
  - *Balance of Trade:* The difference between export and import. When the value of export exceeds the value of imports, it is called a favorable balance of trade.